

FREEDOM INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL
PRACTICE PAPER
ENGLISH

CLASS: XI

MAX MARKS: 80

TIME: 3 HOURS

General Instructions:

1. The Question Paper contains THREE sections-READING, WRITING and LITERATURE.
2. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.

Section A – Reading Skills (26 marks)

1	Read the following text.	10
1)	We often come across situations and incidents, which appear quite contradictory to the known laws of Nature, creating doubts about the impartiality of divine justice. For instance, an honest, duty-conscious, morally elevated person is often seen caught in adversities in one form or another or is suddenly struck with a great misfortune in life as though he/she were being punished by God for a great sin. On the other hand, we find persons engaged in the worst types of corrupt practices living in peace and prosperity. An idler wins a jackpot or inherits a fortune from unexpected quarters, whereas a hard-working intelligent person is found suffering endlessly for want of basic necessities. One person achieves great success with little effort, whereas another does not succeed in spite of his best efforts. Such phenomena are popularly ascribed to the role of fate.	
2)	Unprecedented natural calamities like famine, epidemics, tornadoes and floods, damage by lightning and earthquakes and untimely death are also commonly attributed to the will of God and called predestined. Such unexpected happenings as financial loss, accidents, sudden mental/ physical disability and physical separation from a dear one are also attributed to fate.	
3)	Such unexpected adversities are rare, but they do occur in life. At times, they leave such deep imprints on the psyche, that it is not possible to ignore them. Those who are not familiar with the mysteries of divine justice become very much perplexed by such experiences and form prejudiced opinions, which, in some form or the other, hinder their mental and spiritual progress. Many become resentful towards God, blame and abuse Him for favouritism and injustice. A few even become atheists, considering the futility of worshipping God who does not respond to prayer in distress, despite their prolonged adherence to religiosity. Then there is a class of devotees who serve the saints and worship deities in expectation of some material gains. However, if they are visited by some failure, unfavourable circumstances, or mishap coincidentally, their adoration changes to contempt or disbelief.	
4)	There are quite a few believers in this world who correlate people, places and things with good and bad luck. Such superstitions have caused extreme misery to innocent persons. The root cause for such irrational behaviour is the belief that whatever comes to pass is predestined by God and the beings created by Him have absolutely no role in shaping their own destiny. Quite a few persons in this world forsake their responsibility in the mistaken belief that gain and loss are predestined, there is no necessity of personal effort.	

	Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.	10
i	What would be a suitable title for the above passage? A. Adversities in Life B. Role of Destiny in Life C. Life is Unfair D. Life is Transient	1
ii	Assertion (A): Superstitions often cause harm to innocent people. Reason (R): Superstitions are rooted in the belief that destiny is entirely predestined by God. A. Both A and R are true, and R is the correct explanation of A. B. Both A and R are true, but R is not the correct explanation of A. C. A is true, but R is false. D. A is false, but R is true.	1
iii	Which of the following is NOT an example of a phenomenon attributed to the role of fate? A. An idler wins a jackpot B. An honest person caught in adversity C. Corrupt people living in peace D. A conscientious person getting success in life	1
iv	Choose the sentence where 'adversities' has NOT been used in the same context as in paragraph 3 of the passage. A. Despite facing numerous adversities, she never gave up on her dreams and worked hard to succeed. B. Adversities like financial loss and natural calamities often test a person's resilience. C. The protagonist in the novel overcomes several adversities to reunite with her family. D. The adversities of the meal made it the best dish that I have ever tasted.	1
v	What can be inferred about the author's perspective on the belief in fate and predestination? A. The author supports a blind belief in fate. B. The author views fate as a justification for personal failures. C. The author emphasizes a balanced approach towards personal effort and divine justice. D. The author believes that everything is controlled solely by God.	1
vi	How does the passage highlight the psychological and spiritual impact of adversities on individuals?	2
vii	What is the one reason mentioned in the passage that leads some people to resent God or become atheists? A. Their belief in superstition B. The perception of divine justice as unfair C. Sudden financial success of corrupt people D. The role of saints and deities in bringing material gain.	1
viii	How does the passage explain the contrasting outcomes in people's lives despite their efforts or moral standing?	2
2	Read the following text.	8
1)	Politics and now Pollution keep Delhi forever in the news, but a third P (Population Growth) has gone missing from the discourse on the capital: population growth, which has soared during the last two decades and its disastrous fallout.	

2)	Already, India's capital city is the world's second most populous urban agglomeration. The future is even more frightening: a United Nations report released in mid-2018 says Delhi could be the world's most populous city by 2028 with 37.2 million people. That is eight million more in just 10 years.																													
3)	According to the report called World Urbanisation Prospects 2018 by the Population Division of the UN Department of Economic and Social Affairs, the population of Delhi and its immediate neighbourhood is now estimated to be 29 million, second only to Tokyo with 37 million people. But Delhi will zoom past Tokyo, whose population is projected to decline to 36.8 million by 2028.																													
4)	Will Delhi be worth living in? Can the city state of Delhi escape the pressure put on it by an ever-expanding National Capital Region (NCR), which touches as far as Alwar now? Are we prepared at all for this population explosion? Fig 1. Population growth in the major cities Population in the years 2010, 2020 and 2030 <table><thead><tr><th>City</th><th>2010</th><th>2020</th><th>2030</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>New York</td><td>17.5</td><td>18.5</td><td>20.0</td></tr><tr><td>Tokyo</td><td>37.0</td><td>37.5</td><td>36.0</td></tr><tr><td>Beijing</td><td>16.0</td><td>20.0</td><td>24.0</td></tr><tr><td>Delhi</td><td>23.0</td><td>30.0</td><td>37.0</td></tr><tr><td>Mumbai</td><td>17.0</td><td>20.0</td><td>25.0</td></tr><tr><td>Mexico</td><td>20.0</td><td>23.0</td><td>28.0</td></tr></tbody></table>	City	2010	2020	2030	New York	17.5	18.5	20.0	Tokyo	37.0	37.5	36.0	Beijing	16.0	20.0	24.0	Delhi	23.0	30.0	37.0	Mumbai	17.0	20.0	25.0	Mexico	20.0	23.0	28.0	
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5)	In a small office in Delhi's India Habitat Centre, a group of urban planners – all belonging to the National Institute of Urban Affairs (NIUA) – have just started collecting baseline data on land, housing, transport, environment, heritage, water, among others, for Master Plan for Delhi (MPD) 2041. “Our deadline for preparing the Master Plan is 2021. But unlike its earlier editions, it won't be a flat 20-year plan. This one will be divided into various achievables, say, for every five years,” says Nilesh Rajadhyaksha, lead coordinator of MPD and urban specialist in NIUA. The NIUA – an autonomous research and advisory body that comes under the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs – has been roped in by the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) to undertake this colossal strategy plan for Delhi 2041. The master plan, MPD-2021, which was notified in 2007 and was prepared by an in-house team of the DDA, expired in 2021.																													

6)	The concern is that a sense of urgency to fix Delhi is missing. Many crucial elements of MPD-2021 still remain on paper, with just two years left for the plan to expire. AK Jain, former commissioner-planning in DDA and key architect of MPD-2021, gives a long list of what have not been implemented. The master plan talks about brownfield redevelopment of rehabilitation colonies such as Lajpat Nagar, Old Rajendra Nagar and Mukherjee Nagar, which were originally meant for Partition refugees.	
7)	Nothing has been done on that front so far. Nor for the redevelopment of 45 resettlement colonies such as Ambedkar Nagar and Trilokpuri, which were developed during Emergency to rehabilitate slum dwellers. The rejuvenation of the Yamuna is also on the plan, but the river remains severely polluted in the Delhi stretch.	
	Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.	8
i	Based on reading of the text, state a point to challenge the statement. All elements of MPD-2021 have been implemented.	1
ii	Choose the most appropriate definition of the word ‘agglomeration’ as given in the text. A. The process by which business in the same industry flock together in a particular geographical area. B. The action or process of collecting in a mass. C. A heap or cluster of disparate elements. D. A large densely and contiguously populated area.	1
iii	Based on the given graph, choose the option that lists the statement that is true. A. The population of New York is growing exponentially. B. The population of Tokyo has remained the same over 10 years. C. Beijing and Delhi will see a decline in population growth. D. Mexico is expected to see a very inconsistent growth.	1
iv	What problem will prevail even if the Master Plan is implemented in its entirety?	1
v	Choose the option that DOES NOT list the correct set of cause and effect. A. Cause: Rapid population growth in Delhi over the last two decades. Effect: Strain on land, housing, transport, environment, and other urban resources. B. Cause: Delhi's population projected to increase to 37.2 million by 2028, surpassing Tokyo. Effect: Delhi is at risk of becoming the world's most populous city, intensifying urban challenges and worsening quality of life. C. Cause: MDP-2021 has been divided into various achievable plans. Effect: The redevelopment of Lajpat Nagar and Mukherjee Nagar has been successfully completed.	1

	D. Cause: Lack of urgency in implementing the Master Plan for Delhi (MPD-2021). Effect: Crucial urban development goals, such as the redevelopment of rehabilitation and resettlement colonies, remain unfulfilled.	
vi	Which of the following colonies were originally meant for Partition refugees. - Ambedkar Nagar - Lajpat Nagar - Mukherjee Nagar - Trilokpuri A. i and ii B. i and iii C. ii and iii D. all of the above	1
vii	With regard to the bar graph, which is/are the most populated and the least populated city/cities at present?	2
3	Read the passage given below.	8
1)	Convenient, inexpensive, nutritious, good for you and delicious: they have it all! Peanuts are the most popular and consumed nuts in the United States and can be found nearly everywhere. Perfect for a quick snack, a handful of these nuts provide a highly nutrient food for less than 200 calories.	
2)	According to the Peanut Institute, the peanut plant originated in South America, probably first domesticated and cultivated in the valleys of Paraguay. Spread by European explorers and traders, the plant eventually reached Asia, Africa and North America. Millions of peanuts are grown and consumed around the world. Peanuts started to be produced in large quantities in the 1900s due to the growing popularity of peanut butter, peanut candies and other peanut products.	
3)	Although peanuts come in many varieties, four main types can be found in the United States: Virginia Peanuts, Runner Peanuts, Spanish Peanuts and Valencia Peanuts. Peanuts are a wonderful food, rich in nutrients and flavour. The combination of fibre and protein in peanuts satiates hunger. Thus, eating peanuts helps manage weight and provides the key nutrients that are important to diets. Peanuts are also natural energy boosters that contain healthy fats, proteins and antioxidants. Research shows that eating peanuts can decrease your risk of heart disease, diabetes and other chronic health conditions. Peanut butter is also full of the good kind of fat also known as monounsaturated fat that is heart-healthy and prevents belly fat that people get from carbohydrates or saturated fat.	
4)	For centuries, peanuts have been used in many culinary applications, including Chinese, African and Western cooking — in stews, sauces, mixed dishes, boiled or even plain — nourishing various populations with an enjoyable flavour. The great advantages of using peanuts in the kitchen are their availability and affordability. Peanut oil is also becoming a popular option for cooking because of its healthy fats and high cooking temperature. On the sweet side, peanuts are commonly used for ice cream, brownie mix or cake batter. Peanut flour is an asset for pastry chefs because of its ability to act as a fat binder in confectionery products or to add flavour and extend shelf-life.	

5)	A long-time American favourite, peanuts offer countless healthy properties and natural nutrition to all populations and age groups, peanuts enhance the flavour and boost the nutritional value of food dishes from breakfast and snacks to dinner and dessert. As a nut, oil, flour or butter, peanuts are a very versatile and tasty ingredient.	
A	On the basis of your understanding of the above passage, make notes on it using headings and subheadings. Use recognisable abbreviations (minimum four).	5
B	Write a summary of the above passage in about 50 words.	3
	<u>Section B – Grammar and Creative Writing Skills (23 marks)</u>	
4	Fill in the blanks with the correct tense of the word given in the bracket: It was a hot day, so I (1)_____to prepare salad for lunch. Outside, the children (2)_____ in the garden. Suddenly I (3)_____a loud noise, followed by a scream. I ran outside to see what (4)_____. (1) A. decided B. was deciding C. will decide D. decided will (2) A. played B. were playing C. will be playing D. were playing (3) A. will have heard B. heard C. was hearing D. had heard (4) A. will happen B. would have happened C. had happened D. happen	4x1=4
5	Rearrange the words / phrases given below to form meaningful sentences.	3x1=3
i	had/ he/ a medal/ winning/ my/ until/ about / I /told/ known/ not/ him/ had	
ii	fear/ farmers/ displacement/ large-scale/ economic/ special/ from/ zones	
iii	issue/work/to/governments/this/and/must/individuals/combat/together	
6	Attempt any ONE of two, in about 50 words.	1x3=3
A	You are Karan Kumar/ Karuna Bajaj, a leading lawyer practising in Surat. You want to buy an independent house at City Light Road to be used as office-cum-residence. Draft an advertisement in about 50 words for the classified columns of a local newspaper. You can be contacted at 45645678.	
	OR	
B	You are Ashok/Ashita of Sitapur, Lucknow. You have got an assignment abroad and would be leaving for it soon. You have a television and a washing machine to sell. Draft a suitable advertisement to be displayed on the society's noticeboard.	
7	Attempt any ONE of two, in about 50 words.	1x3=3
A	The Tourism Department of the Government of Uttaranchal has introduced an exciting initiative to promote adventure sports and eco-tourism in the state. Design an engaging poster for display at key public locations or for publication in newspapers to highlight this new development.	

	OR	
B	Your school is participating in 'each one teach one' drive. As the Secretary of the Social Work Club, design a poster for the same. Give the necessary details.	
8	Attempt any ONE of two, in about 150- 200 words.	1x5=5
A	You are Ali/Alia, Head girl / Head boy of your school. You are deeply disturbed by the rising cases of aggressive behaviour of students in your school. You decide to speak during the morning assembly about it. Write a speech on 'Indiscipline in Schools' in 120-150 words.	
	OR	
B	You are Raima/Ritvik, the school captain. You have been asked to speak on the topic 'Stereotyped images are hard to break'. Write a speech in 120 – 150 words.	
9	Attempt any ONE of two, in about 150- 200 words.	1x5=5
A	'Brain drain is not a bane for a developing country like india.' Write a debate in 120-150 words either for or against this view. You are Shyam/ Shyamala.	
	OR	
B	'Is online privacy a right or a privilege?' Write a debate in 120-150 words either for or against this view. You are Karthik/ Keerthi.	

Section C- Literature (31 marks)

10	Read the given extracts and answer the questions for any ONE of the two, given.	3x1=3
A	<i>Some twenty — thirty — years later She'd laugh at the snapshot. "See Betty And Dolly," she'd say, "and look how they Dressed us for the beach." The sea holiday Was her past, mine is her laughter. Both wry With the laboured ease of loss.</i>	
i	Choose the correct option that indicates the meaning of the phrase "the sea holiday was her past, mine is her laughter". A. The speaker's holiday experience was different from her mother's. B. The mother's joy is the central memory for the speaker, which is also in the past now. C. The speaker feels extremely happy over the memories of her mother. D. Both the sea holiday and the mother's laughter bring sadness to the speaker.	
ii	What is the function of the juxtaposition between "her past" and "mine" in the lines? A. To suggest that the speaker's past is irrelevant to the present. B. To highlight the generational gap between the speaker and their mother. C. To emphasize how memories are differently valued by individuals. D. To show how memories evolve into distinct meanings over time.	

iii	Which option identifies the correct usage of "wry" in the context of the given poem? A. Her wry smile revealed her deep joy in reliving the carefree childhood memories. B. The laughter of her wry tone suggested an indifference to the loss she had experienced. C. They winced under their wry faces, afraid to stand and afraid to run away. D. His wry expression conveyed an acceptance of the bittersweet memories of the past.							
	OR							
B	<i>She enters the thickness, and a machine starts up Of chitterings, and a tremor of wings, and trillings — The whole tree trembles and thrills. It is the engine of her family. She stokes it full, then flirts out to a branch-end Showing her barred face identity mask</i>							
i	The phrase "the engine of her family" suggests _____. A. the mechanical and indifferent nature of her actions. B. the power and dominance she holds over her family. C. the central role the nature plays in sustaining her family's life. D. the chaotic and disorganised nature of her environment.							
ii	What is the significance of the phrase "Showing her barred face identity mask" in the poem? A. It highlights the uniqueness of her appearance as part of her concealment. B. It suggests a deliberate concealment of her true nature. C. It implies a rejection of individuality for the sake of her family. D. It portrays her as trapped and confined within her role.							
iii	Choose the option to match the following <table><tr><td>1. The whole tree trembles and thrills.</td><td>a. onomatopoeia</td></tr><tr><td>2. chitterings...and trillings</td><td>b. metaphor</td></tr><tr><td>3. engine of her family</td><td>c. personification</td></tr></table> A. 1-b 2-c 3-a B. 1-c 2-a 3-b C. 1- a 2- c 3-b D. 1-c 2-b 3-a	1. The whole tree trembles and thrills.	a. onomatopoeia	2. chitterings...and trillings	b. metaphor	3. engine of her family	c. personification	
1. The whole tree trembles and thrills.	a. onomatopoeia							
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3. engine of her family	c. personification							
11	Read the given extracts and answer the questions for any ONE of the two, given.	3x1=3						
A	<i>Rajendra motioned him to silence and started pacing the room, obviously under great mental strain. Finally, he turned around and said, "Professor Gaitonde, I will try to rationalise your experience on the basis of two scientific theories as known today. Whether I succeed or not in convincing</i>							

	<i>you of the facts, only you can judge — for you have indeed passed through a fantastic experience: or, more correctly, a catastrophic experience!"</i>	
i	Rajendra said "only you can judge" to Professor Gaitonde because _____. A. the experience was difficult to understand for anyone other than the professor B. the professor is the only one with the necessary expertise C. Rajendra believes the experience is too unbelievable to be true D. Rajendra is unsure of the validity of the professor's experience	
ii	Choose the option that most nearly explains the term "rationalise" in the passage. A. recognise something so as to make it more consistent B. describe something scientifically C. dismiss the unscientific theories D. attempt to explain or justify in a logical manner	
iii	Draw any one inference from the given statement. “....for you have indeed passed through a fantastic experience: or, more correctly, a catastrophic experience!”	
	OR	
B	<i>He was just a teenager when he died. The last heir of a powerful family that had ruled Egypt and its empire for centuries, he was laid to rest laden with gold and eventually forgotten. Since the discovery of his tomb in 1922, the modern world has speculated about what happened to him, with murder being the most extreme possibility. Now, leaving his tomb for the first time in almost 80 years, Tut has undergone a CT scan that offers new clues about his life and death —and provides precise data for an accurate forensic reconstruction of the boyish pharaoh.</i>	
i	What is the significance of Tut leaving his tomb for the first time in almost 80 years? A. It symbolises a cultural shift in how ancient artefacts are treated. B. It allows scientists to re-evaluate historical assumptions about his death. C. It signifies the beginning of new archaeological excavations in Egypt. D. It demonstrates advancements in modern burial practices.	
ii	‘The discovery and study of Tutankhamun’s tomb reveal about the intersection of modern science and ancient history’. Justify.	
iii	What does the phrase "laden with gold and eventually forgotten" suggest about ancient Egyptian practices and Tutankhamun's legacy? A. Egyptians valued wealth over preserving their rulers' memory. B. Tutankhamun was historically not so important compared to other pharaohs. C. Burials were conducted with grandeur, but historical memory faded over time. D. His death led to the rapid decline of Egyptian wealth and culture.	

12	Read the given extracts and answer the questions for any ONE of the two, given.	4x1=4
A	<i>The noose was set up somewhat high. Each man was measured by and by. But only one man was so tall He fitted. One man. That was all. He was the King. His Majesty Was therefore hanged by Royal Decree.</i>	
i	In the context of the poem, what is the significance of the phrase "Each man was measured by and by"? A. It reflects the fairness and impartiality of the process. B. It implies a systematic, almost ludicrous method to identify the victim. C. It shows the efficiency of the royal justice system. D. It highlights the equality of all men before the law.	
ii	The line "He was the King. His Majesty... Was therefore hanged by Royal Decree" is an example of: A. Dramatic irony, as the King becomes the victim of his own law. B. Tragic heroism, as the King sacrifices himself for fairness. C. Satire, mocking the absurdity of authority and justice. D. Poetic justice, as the King deserved the punishment.	
iii	What inference can you draw from the outcome of the situation described in the poem?	
iv	Why was the noose set up?	
	OR	
B	<i>DORIS: [moving to the settee; anxiously] Mummy, you don't mean you're not going to do anything on Saturday and Sunday?</i> <i>MRS PEARSON: [airily] No, I wouldn't go that far. I might make a bed or two and do a bit of cooking as a favour. Which means, of course, I'll have to be asked very nicely and thanked for everything and generally made a fuss of. But any of you forty-hour-a-weekers who expect to be waited on hand and foot on Saturday and Sunday, with no thanks for it, are in for a nasty disappointment. Might go off for the week-end perhaps.</i>	
i	What does the phrase "waited on hand and foot" most closely mean in this context? A. To work tirelessly for someone else's benefit. B. To control someone's actions. C. To ensure that someone is well taken care of. D. To treat someone with excessive care and attention.	
ii	What is Mrs. Pearson's tone in this excerpt? A. Angry and accusatory B. Indifferent and disinterested C. Witty and assertive D. Defensive and emotional	

iii	Explain any one reason for Mrs. Pearson's changed behaviour.	
iv	Identify the underlying message of Mrs. Pearson's statement about going off for the weekend. A. She is serious about leaving her responsibilities behind. B. She wants her family to consider how much they rely on her. C. She desires freedom and independence from her family. D. She is threatening to abandon her duties permanently.	
13	Answer any TWO of the following questions in 40-50 words.	2x3=6
i	In " <i>The Portrait of a Lady</i> ", the narrator describes his grandmother's simplicity and spiritual devotion. How do these traits contribute to the overall message of the story about the value of tradition and inner peace in the face of change?	
ii	In the poem Father to Son, why does the father feel a sense of "silence" between him and his son, and what does this reveal about his internal struggle?	
iii	In "The Voice of the Rain", the rain speaks of its purpose in nurturing the earth and rising back to the sky. How does this metaphorical cycle reflect the journey of a song?	
iv	In "Childhood", the poet reflects on the loss of innocence as one grows older. How does the poet's realisation about the change in perception from childhood to adulthood emphasise the theme of self-awareness?	
14	Answer any ONE of the following questions in 40-50 words.	1x3=3
i	In "The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse", Aram justifies by saying that they are just taking the horse, not stealing it because of their family's reputation for honesty. How does this reflect his moral conflict, and what does it reveal about his understanding of right and wrong?	
ii	How does the role reversal between Mrs. Pearson and Mrs. Fitzgerald in "Mother's Day" serve as a tool to highlight the need for self-respect and assertiveness in relationships?	
15	Answer any ONE of the following questions in 120-150 words.	1x6=6
A	The theme of journey is central in the lessons Silk Road and Adventure, though it is explored in different contexts and perspectives. Both stories emphasise that a journey is not just a physical expedition but also an emotional, intellectual, and scientific experience. Bring out the differences between them with suitable examples from both texts.	
	OR	
B	The lesson "We Are Not Afraid to Die... If We Can All Be Together" is an inspiring tale that highlights how extreme adversity can be a crucible for human behaviour. While the narrative primarily focuses on the positive traits of courage, resilience, and unity, it also subtly reflects the vulnerability and emotional toll that such situations can impose. Elucidate with suitable examples from the lesson.	

16	Answer any ONE of the following questions in 120-150 words.	1x6=6
A	In the lesson "The Address", the protagonist's journey to Mrs. Dorling's house is not just a physical one but also a metaphorical journey of self-discovery and emotional reckoning. Critically analyse how the story uses the theme of memory, loss, and identity to reflect on the effects of war.	
	OR	
B	In "Birth", the character of Dr. Andrew Manson undergoes a significant transformation during the course of the story. Critically analyse how the lesson highlights his professional duty, emotional resilience, and the triumph of human will and the relevance of these values in modern life.	

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